



Universal 3D Printing OS

Group of engineers want to build a usable 3D printing OS so that it could be used on all 3D printers.
<http://dgit.in/3DPrinterOS>

Feature

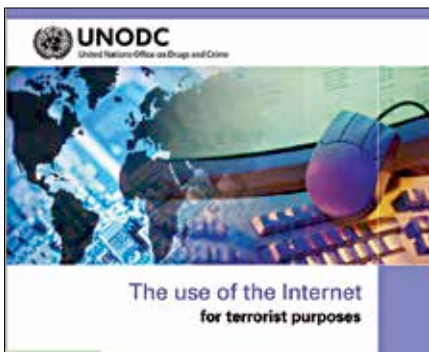


Oops!

Social media has negligible cost of entry, is free to use for life, and provided you are careful, lets you exist anonymously on the Internet even while you're communicating with hundreds of people. While it's possible to be anonymous and discreet on a social network like Facebook, something like Twitter makes it even easier to conceal yourself behind a shield of anonymity. No wonder a 2012 study by the University of Haifa found that 90 percent of terrorist activities online were being conducted through social media. The study discovered that not only were terrorist organisations using social networks to spread the 'word' but were also joining various groups and 'friending' people using fake identities in order to gather information and spy on them.

Which Social Networks?

Terrorists have especially taken a shine to Twitter, the ubiquitous micro-blogging tool that's as much a part of our daily lives today as any other name in technology. In fact, in April 2013, the Syrian Electronic Army, branded by the FBI as a terrorist organisation, hacked the Associated Press' Twitter handle and tweeted that the White House had been attacked and U.S. President Obama injured. This led to the New York Stock Exchange



An official document by UNODC.

losing \$136 billion. As such, a study by the Woodrow Wilson Center found that Twitter was even more popular than Facebook among terrorists as a quick, efficient way to communicate among themselves or broadcast to the world.

A UN report published in 2012 (PDF) also underscored how important both Facebook and Twitter had become to terrorist organisations and highlighted how the absence of borders online had made it easier for them to communicate with each other.

A report written for the American Department of Homeland Security in 2010 revealed how Facebook was being used by terrorist organisations to share "recipes" for IEDs (Improvised Explosive Devices) and to teach combat through instructional YouTube videos on topics like handling and taking care of an AK-47 rifle and "tactical shooting". The same report also recounted the steps that terrorist sympathisers were asked to take when creating a new Facebook account including the mandatory use of Tor software for maintaining online anonymity and using unique passwords for every account they use even across different websites.

Governments have also pointed fingers at social messaging apps such as Skype and Whatsapp as being hotbeds of terrorist activity. Last year, the Pakistani government decided to ban the use of Whatsapp and Skype in the Sindh province alleging that they were being used by "terrorists and criminal elements."

The Dramatis Personae

The intrinsic link between the desire to spread propaganda and the ease with which one can do it through social networks makes social media a valuable tool for radicals and terrorists. As a result, there are a countless number of such organisations and people who have taken to social networks like Facebook and Twitter as easily as fish to water. Here are three such organisations that have especially made a big splash with their use of social networks:

Al Qaeda

The most notorious terrorist organisation on the planet has had an unbroken



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